

Wi-Fi Wolkswagen

If you drive off with the newer versions of the Wolkswagen Routan, you will get a moving hotspot, as the car comes with a Autonet Wi-Fi kit.



If you know exactly where your PC is going to be you can opt for a directional antenna which will provide a much better signal strength in a certain direction and location

2,143 we reckon this router is a steal. Linksys' WRT54G2 is a smart looker that also just missed out on an award, its faster than the Belkin Wireless G Router and costs around a thousand rupees more, if you want a bit more speed this may be a better bet. If you happen to want blazing speed and still don't want to burn your pocket we have a stunner for you - Netgear's WNR2000. A sweet looking router that's well-built, feature-rich, highly configurable and to top it all a sterling performer with superb scores all round. At a price of Rs. 4,720, it is the second fastest device in the entire test and is less than half the price of the costliest model. If you want a Draft N router and have five thousand bucks to burn, you couldn't spend it any better, and the WNR2000 is our unanimous choice for Editor's Pick.

Above Rs. 5,000

While some might argue there's not much value to be had when one goes burning upward of Rs. 5,000 on a router, we disagree.

Features matter to some users as do security, configurability



Linksys WRT160N

DLINK DAP-1150 - ROUTE ME NOT

Dlink sent us the only access point in this comparison, the DAP-1150 - a solid little AP with a large antenna and a good build. The entire device is black and has a silver front bezel.

It's attractive enough to warrant attention and Dlink thought it prudent to supply it with a hardware security (WPS) button and a security indicator. It's wall mountable as well and screws have been supplied for the same. The interface is pretty simple and the firmware certainly newbie friendly. In terms of performance, sadly this little thing cannot keep up with many of its 802.11G brethren let alone the Draft N speed demons. We were surprised to see it fail the transfer in zone 3 and tried this thrice. With a price tag of Rs. 3,192, it's as costly as routers that are faster and as such we suggest giving it a wide berth.

and build quality. Linksys' WRT160N is another speed demon not very far from the fastest trio in terms of throughput. It's a great looking router that delivers the best of features and performance at this price point and is our Best Buy award winner. Another highly recommended device is the Linksys WRT310N - a smart, feature packed router and the second fastest wireless device in test. At Rs. 7,999 it is costly, however advanced users will swallow the bill with little fuss. The Linksys WRT610N is the most expensive device in test at Rs. 10,999 and while few will be looking to spend that much we guarantee blazing speeds and features galore. It has USB

connectivity as an option and is the fastest device in test winning the Best Performer award. In fact it was faster than the Netgear DGN2000 that won the Best Performer award in the ADSL router category. With nearly 20 megabits per second for sequential transfers in zone 3 and the highest score of 12.3 megabits per second for assorted transfers the WRT610N is the one for you if you demand the best.

Although there were some truly amazing routers in this comparison and we were surprised both by the prices and their firmware features and options careful readers will notice that while we praised some of these devices for their performance we weren't happy with the overall performance on display. Our maximum performance figure was 60 and the fastest performer just about crossed 35, (35.09 for the

Linksys WRT610N), this shows the performance overall was well short of both our expectations and acceptable levels. And this is not really a device flaw. When a device supporting a standard that promises 75 megabits per second delivers 40 megabits per second we call it a new technology that's yet to mature. Like SATA 2.0 for hard drives or USB 2.0 for USB devices we're yet to see theoretical limits even remotely approached. However five megabytes per second is rather ludicrous even for a specification that hasn't fully emerged. And what about signal attenuation? If even eight antennas cannot boost a signal past 88 percent when the router and client are just four feet apart with thin air



Linksys WRT610N

between, what will? To mention nothing of that fact that a single 3-inch thick wooden partition is enough to cause signal losses of more than 50 per cent! Draft N has seen two revisions and there is still no final standard so manufacturers are free to include or drop features. While this is a liberty of sorts it's also a pitfall since very few people are sure just how many of these routers will quality as 802.11N devices when the standard is finalised by September this year. We're waiting impatiently to test the new lot of devices based on the final 802.11N specification. Sure, things have gotten a lot better (read faster) since our last test but we're an impatient bunch and the orange glow dancing on the horizon holds much promise.

Contact Sheet

Wi-Fi Comparison Test

Brand	Company Name	Phone Number	Web site
Buffalo	Buffalo INC	+91-99713 52580	www.buffalo-asia.com
Belkin	Belkin Corporation	+91-99996 36133	www.belkin.com
Apple	Apple India Pvt. Ltd.	+91-80-2574 4646	www.apple.co.in
Linksys	Cisco Systems (India) Pvt. Ltd.	+91-22-4043 4020	www.in.linksys.com
Netgear	NETGEAR Technologies India Pvt. Ltd	+91-11-2620 7270	www.netgear.com
Dlink	D-Link India Limited	+91-22-2659 1088	www.dlink.co.in
Senao	Rashi Peripherals Pvt. Ltd.	+91-22-6709 0828	www.rptechindia.com
Compex	Rashi Peripherals Pvt. Ltd.	+91-22-6709 0828	www.rptechindia.com